Chapter 11

Kara naono – Vines, aerial roots, fibres and strings

Ruth Sima Rigamu & Ondria Tavagaga

(a) (b) (c)

Figure 1: (a) *Kara aisi* – A weed, (b) *Kara ariono* – A vine, (c) *Kara kanono* – Some strings[1]

(1)	***Kara aisi***	**The weed called *aisi***
(2)	*O kara aisi, eve o meho kara naono to abeabe batana tea maa kasuana vaa Hanatana.*	The *aisi*, it is a string-like plant that is creeping on the beaches of Hanatana.
(3)	*O kara aisi bona na tei nana kasuana.*	This *aisi* is found on the ground.
(4)	*Ahiki vira ta kiu teve vo teara.*	Actually, it does not have any use for us.

[1]The word *kara* is a kind of classifier for plants and other things that look like a string. In Adjectival Phrases that relate to a *kara*-N compound as a predicate or modifier this classifier is repeated, see Chapter 11:48 and Chapter 11:78.

Ruth Sima Rigamu & Ondria Tavagaga. 2026. *Kara naono* – vines, aerial roots, fibres and strings. In Ulrike Mosel (ed.), *The material culture of the Teop people of Bougainville*, 113–123. Berlin: Language Science Press. DOI: 10.5281/zenodo.22880248

(5)	***Kara ariono***	***Ariono* vine**
(6)	*O kara ariono mee, eve o meho kara koris o kara mataa.*	The *ariono* vine, it is a good vine.
(7)	*Eve to vagana ni ria abana tahii.*	It is used by the men for fishing in the sea.
(8)	*Beori nao tahii, eori toro gono bona kara ariono mene a vavaatoa.*	When they go (fishing) in the sea, they must get the *ariono* string for kite-fishing.[2]
(9)	*Na paku vavaatoa ni rori bona kara ariono.*	They do kite fishing with the *ariono* string.

(10)	***Kara bao***	**Grass**
(11)	*A kara bao eve a tabaan teo burumakao.*	Grass is the food of cows.
(12)	*Nabunuu roho enam ahiki to kara bao.*	In the past we did not have any grass.
(13)	*O burumakao he nomaa koa, meori paa ma neba bata kiri bari bono kara bao.*	But the cows came, and they planted the grass for them.
(14)	*Mea naba kasi hanana paa dee taataana bata maa bari.*	And the road builders brought it here along the coast.
(15)	*Rerau, mepaa raha bata maa.*	And so, it spread out here.
(16)	*Me nomana, amaa mohina teara na hapus kurus nana tea kara bao.*	And today our gardens are full of grass.

(17)	***Kara kave***	**Net vine**
(18)	*O kara kave, eve o meho kara koris vai to tei me nana bona kiu a beera sana.*	The net vine is a vine that has a very important function.
(19)	*Nabunuu roho beo kara kave vai hiki nana,*	In the past, when there was not any net vine,
(20)	*ahiki koa ta an iana teara.*	we could not eat any fish.
(21)	*Eikou o kara kave to paku riori bona kanono,*	Because (it was) the net vine from which they made the string,

[2]See Chapter 34:8. When used as a name for the vine, *kara ariono* is a N3-construction; but when used in the sense of 'string made from *ariono* vines' it is a N2-construction.

(22) *ore paa paku pete bari bona kave mene vagana.* and then they made the net for fishing from it.[3]

(a) (b) (c)

Figure 2: (a) *Kara koris* – Vine, (b) *Kara kuskus* – Passionflower, (c) *Obai* – Bengal calamus

(23) ***Kara koris*** **Vine (generic term)**

(24) *O kara koris, eve o meho kara naono.* The vine is a string-like plant.

(25) *O kara koris bona na tei pete nana rasuu ei mohina.* The vine also grows in the jungle, in the garden.

(26) *O kara koris bona na vaahiroo ni raara, na dao raara bono kara koremana.* This vine we use for soup, we call *koremana* vine.

(27) *Bea moon vahuhu, ore paa vaahiroo bari bono kara koremana, ei bea huhu na moon vagitagita nana,* When a woman gives birth, they give her the *koremana* vine to drink as soup, if the woman's breasts are empty,

(28) *a huhu nae repaa hapus.* so that her breasts become full.

(29) *A pate koris bona o paapao.* This bunch of vines is a vegetable.

(30) *Eve o paapao o mataa.* It is a good vegetable.

(31) *"Hiroo o kara korisi bona."* "Drink this vine as a soup."

(32) ***Kara kuskus*** **Passionflower**

(33) *O kara kuskus eve mee o meho kara koris to tei nana mohina.* The passionflower is a vine that is found in the garden.

[3]See Chapter 29:37ff.

(34)	*O kara kuskus bona na vuavua nana.*	The passionflower bears fruit.
(35)	*Bea vuanae manoto, ore paa tomtomon,*	When its fruit matures, it becomes orange,
(36)	*ei be vuri.*	this means that it is ripe.
(37)	*"Enaa na rake nom tea ani to vua kuskus.*	"I want to eat a passionflower fruit.
(38)	*O vua kuskus bona o vua mataa kurus."*	This passionflower fruit is a very good fruit."
(39)	*O kara kuskus na tei nana rasuu.*	The passionflower is found in the jungle.
(40)	*Na hiri batana tea maa pasunana tenam.*	It is creeping at the head of our gardens.
(41)	*Be vua, ore paa hana batana teo kara nae.*	When it bears fruit, it hangs on its vines.
(42)	*Beove vuri ore paa tomtomon.*	When it ripens, it becomes orange.
(43)	*A vua no kara kuskus a vua mataa kurus.*	The fruit of the passionflower is very good.

(44)	***Kara obai***	**Calamus cane, Sweet Flag**
(45)	*O obai, a kiu nae a beera kurus.*	The calamus cane, its use is very important.[4]
(46)	*O kara obai, eve to paku riori bona sia bara na paku rori bona teevoro ae a teebana.*	The calamus cane is used for making chairs and also used to make tables and beds.
(47)	*O kara obai, eve mee to kisi ni riori bona inu bara tea vaave mee.*	The calamus cane is also used for lashing (the posts and beams of) the house and also for thatching (the roof).
(48)	*O kara obai kou o kara kikis kurus. Na hiri nana teo kasuana, ore paa abe hiava teo naono.*	The calamus cane is very strong. It creeps on the ground, and then it creeps up a tree.
(49)	*O paka obai na toutou nana.*	The calamus leaf is prickly.

[4]See Chapter 6:32ff and Chapter 17:38.

(a) (b) (c)

Figure 3: (a) *Veresun* – Wild banana, (b) *Kara orovi* – Black sheaths, (c) *Vin maata* – Plaiting mats

(50)	***Kara orovi***	**Black sheath of the wild banana**
(51)	*O kara orovi na kurus maa raara teo veresun.*	The black wild banana sheath we cut off the wild banana plant.
(52)	*O veresun bona o paru na dao raara bono orovi.*	This wild banana plant (with) black (leaf sheaths), we call *orovi.*
(53)	*Are paa dee voosu mae,*	(When we have cut off a black sheath,) we carry it home,
(54)	*are paa ma kahu e bona kehaa.*	and scrape it with a seashell.
(55)	*Kahu vakavara, are paa varoava,*	After having scraped (it),
(56)	*are paa varoava e, ore raka.*	we put it in the sun so that it becomes dry.
(57)	*Be raka, are paa rigunue,*	When (it) is dry, we roll it up,
(58)	*matatopo vaa tea vin maata.*	in preparation for weaving mats.
(59)	*Are paa oroorovi nio orovi bona teo vonaha.*	Then we weave this black sheath into a pandanus mat.[5]
(60)	***Kara Pihi***	**Farting Weed**
(61)	*O Kara Pihi o meho subui vaa komana vaan.*	The Farting Weed is a weed in the village.

[5]See Chapter 13:2.

(62)	*O hena Kara Pihi na tei me nana bona ei to kao vo nae.*	The name Farting Weed has been given to it for the following reason.
(63)	*Bean kara e, saka manin takara kurus haa maana, ore antee, bean pihi komana.*	When you try to uproot it, it won't get uprooted, until you fart.

Figure 4: *Kara pihi* – Farting weed

(64)	***Kara rovivi***	***Rovivi*, a kind of sappy vine**
(65)	*O kara rovivi na tei me nana bono marasin.*	The *rovivi* vine contains medicine.
(66)	*Bean kiu bata nom, ean re mosi vohara a mooman,*	When you work and accidentally cut your leg,
(67)	*ean toro gono o kara rovivi,*	you must get a *rovivi* vine,
(68)	*ean re buhaha e.*	then rub it into pulp in your hands.
(69)	*Ean repaa posie bona mosi.*	Then you squeeze the juice out onto the cut.
(70)	*Omana a vihii a beera,*	Sure, the stinging pain is great,
(71)	*evehee pasi too vaha koana a mosi tean.*	but your cut will heal.
(72)	*Eve a taba to mataa suku nae.*	That's why it is good.

(73) *O hum to hata kaakoo nana o kara rovivi, bean mosie, ore paa sapusaka vo tea maa mataman.*
A situation in which the *rovivi* is bad is when you cut it, and the liquid splashes into your eyes.

(74) *O kara rovivi mee saka kikis haana.*
Also, the *rovivi* vine is not strong.

Figure 5: *Kara rovivi*

(a) (b)

Figure 6: (a) *Kara rovivi*, (b) *Buhaha* – Rub leaves into pulp with your hands

(75)	***Kara raviana***	***Raviana* vine**
(76)	*O kara raviana, eve o kara korisi to pampam sinivi ni riori.*	The *raviana* vine, it is a vine that they use to tie up the canoe.
(77)	*Nabunuu komana vai roho suguna vai nomana.*	In the past until today.
(78)	*O kara koris bona o kara kikis kurus,*	This vine is very strong,
(79)	*ei to rake suku riori tea pam sinivi.*	this is why they want (it) for tying up canoes.[6]

(a) (b)

Figure 7: (a) *Raviana* – A vine, (b) *Kara raviana* – *Raviana* string

(80)	***Kara ruhu***	**Aerial roots of the Bengal ficus**
(81)	*O ruhu eve o meho naono to sun nana rasuu.*	The Bengal ficus is a tree that stands in the jungle.
(82)	*O naono bona o beera sana.*	This tree is very big.
(83)	*Eve he o kara berobero.*	It has many aerial roots.
(84)	*O kara nae na ikuu gunaha taneo maana gina tea maa pea nae.*	Its aerial roots hang down from its branches high up.
(85)	*O kara ruhu na topo nana gina ore paa hana gunaha maana vo putaa.*	The aerial roots of the Bengal ficus stick there high up and hang down to the ground.

[6]The *raviana* vine is also used for the *kakavei* 'bamboo frame net', see Chapter 29:63ff.

(86) *O ana ruhu mee na tei me nana bono porete vaa tea kamis nihi.*
The root of the Bengal ficus contains medicine against tooth ache.

(87) *Koto vamuramuraka o sii ana ruhu vai o sii rutaa, ean repaa vaatei e teo hum takepo.*
Bite off and soften a little piece of the Bengal ficus root, then you put it on the place (where a piece of the tooth) split off.

Figure 8: *Ruhu* – Bengal ficus

(88) ***Kara urisi***
Strap of a wild banana sheath

(89) *O kara urisi eve to vateen ni raara.*
The wild banana sheath strap, we use for carrying the backpack.

(90) *Eara na gono rara o urisi teo veresun.*
We get the sheath from the wild banana plant.

(91) *A veresun na tei rori rasuu.*
The wild banana plants are in the jungle.

(92) *Eara na kakapa rara o veresun.*
We pull (the sheath) off the wild banana plant.

(93) *Are paa varoava e ore mahaka.*
Then we put it in the sun, so that it becomes dry.

(94) *Be mahaka, eara re garuhu e, ei beara viru bata rae.* When (it) is dry, we wash it while we are rolling it up.

(95) *Mahaka vai ei, eara repaa gono tea vateen nie.* Now (it) is dry, and we get it for carrying the backpack.[7]

(a) (b) (c)

Figure 9: (a) *Veresun* – Wild banana, (b) *Kara urisi* – Wild banana sheath, (c) *Kakapa o veresun* – Pull (the sheath) off the wild banana plant

(a) (b)

Figure 10: (a) *Varoava* – Drying in the sun, (b) *Vateen* – Carrying the backpack

[7]The strap for carrying backpacks can also be made from hibiscus fibres, see Chapter 12:8.

(96) ***Vunevune***
(97) *O vunevune o kara korisi to hirihiri batana teo kasuana.*
(98) *A vuuaba to vaahito rori teo kara vunevune a Nao Boen.*

Beach morning glory
The beach morning glory is a vine that crawls along on the ground. The clan who owns the beach morning glory is the *Nao Boen*.

(a) (b)

Figure 11: *Vunevune* – Beach morning glory